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GENERAL HEADQUARTERS
FAR EAST COMMAND

33737

CHECK SHEET

(Do not remove from attached sheets)

File No: Subject: Possible Coup d' Etat on Taiwan TI/LJF/RAL/bd

Note No.	From: G-2	To: Chief of Staff	Date: 3 Nov 49

1

1. ASTALUSNA, Taipeh (DA Relay), Radio UNM, 31 Oct, (Tab 1) contains the information that General SUN Li-jen, Commander of combat troops on Taiwan, is showing interest in the possibility of a coup d' etat to create an independent Taiwan. SUN has long maintained a barrier between himself and Taiwanese independence factions in order to force liaison through a third party, and now adequate third party contact is believed to have been made in Hong Kong. At the same time prominent Nationalists on Taiwan have been working hard to bring SUN and Taiwan Governor CHEN Cheng together in order to prevent such a coup d' etat.

2. Recent military losses in China have caused SUN to reason that a coup d' etat in the near future might at least rescue a base from which an attempt to regain China might be made. SUN also feels that such an independent Taiwan would gain US support to prevent Communist occupation of Taiwan.

3. USMILAT, Nanking comments that SUN previously told him that he would, if necessary, take unilateral action to guarantee security of Taiwan. USMILAT feels that SUN has long been entertaining such an idea.

4. G-2 Comment:

Because of lack of unity and proper leadership, the probability of a Taiwanese independence movement has been discounted. However, with a competent leader, such as SUN Li-jen, a successful coup d' etat may be feasible. In SUN's favor would be the personal loyalty of the Chinese and Taiwanese forces that he has trained. Also aiding him would be the friendly attitude of many of the young Air Force Commanders as well as elements of the Armored Force. On the other hand, there appears to be little Taiwanese animosity towards the Chinese regime, particularly since recent land and currency reforms have been effected. Hence a spontaneous uprising on the part of the Taiwanese which might aid SUN may be wishful thinking.

What appears more likely is a showdown between CHEN Cheng and SUN to assume control. There is every reason to believe that the Nationalist Government is well aware of the bitter rivalry that exists between these two men, and that any alleged coup d' etat would involve a fratricide as distinguished from a Taiwanese Independence Movement.

1 Incl
DA Radio 011921Z, 2 Nov 49

NOTED
BY C/S

C.I.A.W.

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GENERAL HEADQUARTERS, FAR EAST COMMAND
ADJUTANT GENERAL'S OFFICE
RADIO AND CABLE CENTER

1940

INCOMING MESSAGE

Secret

JA/ewj/ AFA

ROUTINE

2 Nov 49

FROM : DA WASH DC

TO : CINCFE TOKYO JAPAN

NR : C11921 Z (RELAYS MSG FROM STATE DEPT 011722 Z) (STATE SVC 87 NOV 1, NOON SIGNED ACHESON) (FOLLOWING RELAY FROM ASTALUSNA TAIPEI TO DEPT UNN OCT 31, RPTD TO ARMY, NAVY FOR CNO/DNI, AFOIN, CINCFE, COMNAVFE, CINCPAC, COM 7TH TASK FLEET 310900 Z) (DEPT PASS TO ALL ADDRESSES) (BOOK MESSAGE)

ASTALUSNA has been informed by 4 unrelated sources past week indications are that Sun Li-Jen is showing interest in efforts of Taiwan independence factions contact him learn his feelings toward his leading military coup detat Taiwan. Sun has indirectly long known desires factions interest him in project but has maintained adequate barrier cause them remain in status of seeking Third Party feel him out. Adequate Third Party contact was made this month Hong Kong. General situation following loss of Canton, the belief at Chungking Hsi will probably defect, the ever increasing strength Communists Taiwan, the possible Communist amphib assault Taiwan simultaneously with internal uprising cause Sun reason that military coup soon might rescue at least base from which an attempt can be made to regain China from Communists. Sun further reasons an independent Taiwan would gain US support prevent probable Communist occupation Taiwan and support would eventually necessarily extend to mainland China.

ASTAMILAT Nanking comments that Sun stated privately he would take unilateral action to effect military security ISD should situation warrant. This would take form military coup with either Chinese or US control of ISD but not Generalissimo faction China. ASTAMILAT has long felt without proof that Sun toying with independent China to effect change military control

(over)

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ROUTINE

Secret

Paraphrase not required. Handle as correspondence of classification carried hereon per paragraphs 51*i* and 60a, AR 380-5.

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2 NOV 1949
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ROUTINE

FROM : DA NR : 011921 Z DTD 2 NOV 49 CONT'D

Taiwan. Group prominent China including K C Wu, Secretary General Pu Taiwan Provincial Govt have been working hard to bring Sun and Chen Cheng together form working partnership perhaps to forestall Sun joining independence league Taiwanese. AMCONGEN Taipei concurs. MacDonald.

NO SIG

ACTION : G-2

INFORMATION : COMMANDER IN CHIEF, CHIEF OF STAFF, G-1, G-3, G-4, AG, DIPLOMATIC, JSPOG

23879 ROUTINE Secret TOC : 011921 Z
MCN : 53771